



U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs

Veterans Health Administration
Chief Business Office Purchased Care

PO Box 469060
Denver, CO 80246-9060
<http://www.va.gov/purchasedcare>

Dear Community Provider:

The Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) recognizes the integral role community providers play in the delivery of timely, high quality health care to Veterans. In appreciation of your partnership, we want to keep you informed of near and long-term transformation efforts planned for VA Community Care (VACC).

VA is committed to streamlining our business processes, increasing Veteran access to community care and improving customer service and payment timeliness for you – our valued partners.

We recognize payment timeliness is a critical issue and regret any problems you may experience with our process. As stated in VA's *Plan to Consolidate Community Care Programs* delivered to Congress October 30, 2015, current payment delays are related to a backlog of claims, low electronic data interchange (EDI) submissions, decentralized processes and staffing challenges.

While transformation of our community care programs is a long-term, phased approach, targeted efforts are underway to expedite the claims process. These include a new, online dashboard to monitor backlog reduction, staff recruitment and voluntary overtime, direct meetings with providers, Preliminary Fee Remittance Advice Reports, and increased oversight of contractors responsible for some VACC payments. You can help VA augment these transformation efforts by:

- Utilizing the EDI system and its real-time transactions.
- Submitting final authenticated clinical documentation to VA within 14 days of the date(s) of service.
- Registering for the Vendor Inquiry System—a tool that will allow you to track VA Treasury payment information online.

I encourage you to read more about our consolidation plan at: <http://www.blogs.va.gov/VAntage/23804/va-releases-plan-to-consolidate-community-health-care-programs/>, and to contact your local Community Care office with claims status questions, concerns and feedback. With your help, we will refine our end-to-end community care process to deliver the high-performing network Veterans and community providers deserve.

Sincerely,

David J. Shulkin, M.D.